Samuel Barnes

GROWTH + MARKETING LEADERSHIP | AI + EMERGING TECHNOLOGY

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Executive Profile

I am constantly thinking about how to apply novel solutions to timeless marketing challenges. Throughout my career in tech, I have repeatedly found myself at the helm of communities requiring round-the-clock moderation and products needing an advocate who could connect equally well with novices and experts.

Professional Experience

Head of Growth | Refinery

February 2026 - Present

- I have developed Refinery's website, data room and docs, atlas, and more myself.
- Lead growth, brand, positioning, partnerships, and hands-on agentic engineering for a stealth AI micro-data-center startup.

Founder & CEO | Gaia AI + Symbiocene Labs

December 2024 - Present

- In December 2024, I founded my environmental AI consultancy, Gaia AI, which I have successfully run alongside two developer friends.
- Secured a five-figure MRR engagement with Regen Network for AI and movement-building services. Own strategy, product positioning, partnerships, and ecosystem development.
- Presented the work at the United Nations and developed relationships across regenerative finance, AI, climate, and emerging-technology ecosystems.

Head of Growth | Power Finance

January 2025 - September 2025

- Led growth, brand, social, marketing, and partnerships for a venture developing a yield-bearing synthetic dollar backed by the U.S. electricity market.
- Translated complex energy-finance architecture into product narrative, market positioning, and partner strategy for an early-stage financial platform.

Head of Marketing | Daylight Energy

May 2024 - December 2024

- I spent months working with the leadership team to figure out how best to reach homeowners, coming away with many effective strategies and learnings.
- The most effective initiative we implemented during my tenure was a points campaign (ironically called Lumens) that incentivized homeowners to sign up and rewarded them with exclusive memberships, gift cards, and more.
- We rapidly grew the Discord with inspired meme contests, referral campaigns, and onboarding events.
- During tenure, leads roughly tripled, signups increased approximately 50 percent, and hundreds of new app users registered. Worked with Base on co-marketing, including co-branded content and meetings with its team.

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Professional Experience, Continued

Head of Community | Quantum Temple

December 2023 - March 2024 | Contract

Head of Community | Worldcoin

January 2023 - September 2023

- There, I was tasked with explaining the utility and security of Sam Altman's notorious eyeball-scanning orb to audiences worldwide.
- As the Head of Community at World, I believe I helped turn the project's reputation around by crafting a narrative that showcased how decentralized, anonymous human verification empowered people rather than stole their biometric data.
- Worked on a small marketing team that grew X from approximately 15K to 200K+, LinkedIn from under 2K to 10K+, Telegram from 3K to 15K, and Discord from 5K to 50K.
- Hired and managed five moderators and advocates globally, with direct responsibility for team performance and community operations.
- Oversaw signup events in Berlin, New York, and Tokyo, including contractor management, event coordination, reporting, and KPI tracking.

Community Manager | Forta Network

November 2021 - August 2022

- My first formal tech role was as the community manager at Forta, a developer-focused security project.
- Built a 35K+ Discord, 16K+ X audience, and ambassador network in 20+ countries for a crypto security platform.
- Created video, graphic, and written content for Forta.org and ecosystem channels. Worked with partner teams including Aave, Compound, and OpenSea and maintained CRM and remote community operations.

Education

Columbia University | School of International and Public Affairs

Master of Public Administration, Environmental Science & Policy, 2019. Dean's Fellowship Recipient. 3.8 GPA.

Macaulay Honors College | Hunter College, CUNY

Bachelor of Arts, 2013. Full-tuition and room-and-board academic scholarship.

Additional

Professional Spanish competency. Portfolio: samu.quest. References available upon request.